MODULE 51 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

The Stale Catalogue

Services that closed, ended or were renamed, numbers that moved, and one closure that was reversed. Check the date on every study source.

DOMAIN Cross-cutting EXAM WEIGHT All five MODULE 51 of 52

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An answer that was right two years ago can now name a service you cannot buy, or a limit that has since changed.

How AWS retires a service

- **Maintenance:** closed to new customers, no new features; existing customers continue.
- **Sunset:** a published end date, when operations and support stop.
- **Shutdown:** removed entirely, no longer available in any form.
- Check the **AWS Product Lifecycle page** and each service's availability-change page.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Closed to new customers is the most common state, and the most commonly missed.

Ended or ending

SERVICE	STATUS	USE INSTEAD
AWS App Mesh	Discontinued 30 Sep 2026	Service Connect, VPC Lattice
Amazon Inspector Classic	Support ended 20 May 2026	Amazon Inspector
X-Ray SDKs and daemon	End of support 25 Feb 2027	OpenTelemetry, ADOT
Snowball Edge	Support ends 31 Dec 2026	DataSync, Data Transfer Terminal

ON THE EXAM

The X-Ray service continues. Only its SDKs and daemon are ending.

Closed to new customers

SERVICE	CLOSED	USE INSTEAD
Migration Hub, Discovery Service	7 Nov 2025	AWS Transform
Migration Hub Refactor Spaces	7 Nov 2025	AWS Transform
Incident Manager, Change Manager	7 Nov 2025	Partner tools
CloudTrail Lake	31 May 2026	Trails to S3, CloudWatch
Timestream for LiveAnalytics	20 Jun 2025	Timestream for InfluxDB
Simple AD	30 Jul 2026	Managed Microsoft AD

ON THE EXAM

Also closed: Snow Family devices, FSx File Gateway, Mainframe Modernization managed runtime.

Renamed

OLD NAME	CURRENT NAME
AWS Application Migration Service	AWS Transform MGN
AWS Security Hub (original)	AWS Security Hub CSPM
Route 53 Resolver	Route 53 VPC Resolver
Amazon SageMaker	Amazon SageMaker AI
Control Tower controls library	Control Catalog

ON THE EXAM

A rename changes nothing technical. Do not let an unfamiliar name push you off a right answer.

Numbers that moved

FACT	OLD	CURRENT
SAP passing score	750	720
SQS maximum message	256 KB	1 MiB
EBS gp3 maximum	16,000 IOPS, 16 TiB	80,000 IOPS, 64 TiB
ACM default validity	395 days	198 days
SCP policy language	Limited	Full IAM language

ON THE EXAM

A raised limit removes a workaround. Old material keeps the workaround as the answer.

One closure reversed

SERVICE	HISTORY
AWS CodeCommit	Closed to new customers July 2024
	Back to full GA, November 2025
Scope reversals	Lattice, FIS, Resilience Hub, ARC now examinable

ON THE EXAM

Staleness runs both ways: a source can wrongly call something closed.

Triaging your own material

- **Check the date.** Anything before October 2026 predates the C03 guide.
- **Search for departed names**: Snowball, Migration Hub, App Mesh, Inspector Classic.
- **Re-check limits** it quotes, especially SQS, gp3 and certificates.
- If it calls Lattice, FIS or Resilience Hub out of scope, it was written for C02.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> One test catches most stale sources: does it mention ML-KEM in KMS?

> An energy start-up opening its first AWS account needs a managed time-series database for meter readings, queried with a familiar open-source interface.
>
> A design document written in 2024 specifies Timestream for LiveAnalytics.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Amazon Timestream for LiveAnalytics, as specified

B Amazon Timestream for InfluxDB

C DynamoDB with a custom time-bucketing scheme

D Amazon Keyspaces

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A LiveAnalytics

Closed to new customers since June 2025.

B Timestream for InfluxDB

Managed, open-source interface, open to new accounts.

C DynamoDB scheme

Builds a time-series engine by hand.

D Keyspaces

Wide-column, not a time-series engine.

THE SIGNAL

First AWS account plus a closed service: pick the named successor.

> A bank's audit team, new to CloudTrail Lake, wants to run SQL over seven years of API activity from all 80 accounts in its organisation.
>
> The architecture must use services open to new customers.

What should the solutions architect design?

A. A CloudTrail Lake event data store for the organisation

B. Amazon Detective

C. CloudTrail event history in each account

D. An organisation trail delivering to S3 in the log archive account, queried with Athena

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect design?

A CloudTrail Lake

Closed to new customers since 31 May 2026.

B Detective

Investigation graphs, not SQL; off the list.

C Event history

90 days, one account at a time.

D Org trail, S3, Athena

Central, long retention, SQL, open to all.

THE SIGNAL

Organisation-wide SQL over API history for a new customer: org trail to S3 with Athena.

> An order service sends messages of up to 600 KB to a worker fleet through Amazon SQS. A design from 2023 stores each payload in S3 and sends a pointer, using the SQS Extended Client Library.
>
> The team wants the simplest design that works today.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A. Send the messages directly in SQS, which now accepts up to 1 MiB

B. Keep the Extended Client Library with S3 pointers

C. Move to Kinesis Data Streams

D. Compress every payload below 256 KB

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A **Direct in SQS**
1 MiB limit since August 2025; no S3 step.

B **Extended client**
Works, but a workaround for an old limit.

C **Kinesis**
Changes the delivery model for no reason.

D **Compression**
Extra code to meet a limit that has gone.

THE SIGNAL

A raised limit retires the workaround: SQS messages up to 1 MiB.

> A reporting database on EC2 needs 40,000 IOPS, 1,000 MiB/s throughput and 20 TiB on one volume. Typical latency is acceptable, and Multi-Attach is not needed.
>
> Cost matters, and a 2023 design guide says anything above 16,000 IOPS needs io2.

Which volume should the solutions architect choose?

A. io2 Block Express

B. io1

C. One gp3 volume with 40,000 IOPS and 1,000 MiB/s provisioned

D. Three gp3 volumes striped with RAID 0

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which volume should the solutions architect choose?

A io2 Block Express

Pays for latency and durability not required.

B io1

Older and costlier per IOPS.

C One gp3

Now up to 80,000 IOPS, 2,000 MiB/s, 64 TiB.

D Striped gp3

A workaround for limits that were raised.

THE SIGNAL

IOPS alone no longer forces io2: gp3 reaches 80,000 IOPS since September 2025.

> A design studio opening its first AWS account needs a small managed directory so that 30 Windows and Linux instances can join a domain. There is no on-premises directory.
>
> An older reference architecture recommends Simple AD as the cheapest option.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A. Simple AD, as recommended

B. AD Connector

C. Active Directory on self-managed EC2 instances

D. AWS Managed Microsoft AD, Standard Edition

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Simple AD

Closed to new customers since July 2026.

B AD Connector

Needs an existing directory to connect to.

C Self-managed AD

Not managed; patching and backups are yours.

D Managed Microsoft AD

Managed, small edition, open to new accounts.

THE SIGNAL

New account, small managed directory: Managed Microsoft AD, not Simple AD.

> A logistics company wants continuous vulnerability scanning of EC2 instances and container images across 120 accounts.
>
> Its security runbook describes Inspector assessment templates and an Inspector agent installed on each instance.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A. Follow the runbook with Inspector Classic assessment templates

B. Amazon Inspector enabled organisation-wide through a delegated administrator, with agentless or SSM-based EC2 scanning and ECR scanning

C. Amazon GuardDuty

D. AWS Config managed rules

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Inspector Classic

Support ended 20 May 2026.

B Amazon Inspector

Continuous, org-wide, EC2 and images.

C GuardDuty

Threat detection, not vulnerability scanning.

D Config rules

Configuration, not software vulnerabilities.

THE SIGNAL

Assessment templates and a dedicated agent describe Inspector Classic, which has ended.

What to carry out of this module

- **Closed to new customers** is the commonest change. Watch for new accounts.
- **Renames** change nothing technical: Transform MGN, Security Hub CSPM.
- **Raised limits** retire workarounds: SQS 1 MiB, gp3 80,000 IOPS.
- **Reversals** exist: CodeCommit is open again.
- A runbook or notes from before October 2026 need checking.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Every date in this module was verified in November 2026. Check again if you study later.